

Data Structures 1 – Winter 2025

Assignment A1

General Rules

Item	Details
Deadline	November 16, 11:59 p.m.
Late Penalty	10 pts if submitted Nov 17, 20 pts if submitted Nov 18, 30 pts if submitted Nov 19. No submissions accepted after Nov 20
Group Size	Pairs (two students)
Oral Defense	You may be asked to explain your solution orally. Failure to answer satisfactorily implies a grade 0 in each exercise involved in the discussion.
Academic Integrity	Any detected plagiarism or copying will be reported to the UG office.
Questions	None allowed during the exam period.
Language & Environment	Java (must compile in VS Code and pass all provided tests).
Deliverables	One zip file containing all Java source files (<i>wet part</i>). One PDF file with all written answers (<i>dry part</i>).

1. Big-O Simplification – 5 pts (Dry)

Simplify each expression to **Big-O notation**. Justify your answer using the definition of Big-O and/or its properties.

1. $O(5n^3 + 3n^2 + 100n + 1000) + O(n \cdot \log n)$
2. $O(2^n) \cdot O(n^2) + O(3^n)$
3. $O(\log_2 n) \cdot O(\sqrt{n}) + O(n \cdot \log n)$
4. $O(n!) + O(2^n) \cdot O(n^3)$

2. Sorting Algorithm Analysis – 25 pts (Dry and Wet)

Consider the following pseudo-code:

```
SORT(A):
  set B[i] := 0 for every i between 0 and 9
  for i := 0 to |A| - 1 do
    index := A[i]
    B[index] := B[index] + 1
  k = 0
  for i = 0 to 9 do
    j = 0
    while j < B[i] do
      A[k] := i
      k := k + 1
      j := j + 1
```

- (2 pts, dry) State the **precondition** required for correctness.
 - (5 pts, dry) Determine the **worst-case time complexity**. Provide a detailed asymptotic analysis.
 - (12 pts, dry) Prove **correctness** using the **loop invariant**.
 - (3 pts, wet) Implement the algorithm in **Java**.
 - (3 pts, wet) Supply **meaningful unit tests**.
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3. Palindrome Collector – 30 pts (Dry and Wet)

A **Palindrome Collector** is a sequence that can grow or shrink **only at its two ends** (a double-ended queue) and can always tell—in **constant time**—whether the current sequence is a **palindrome** (reads identically left-to-right and right-to-left).

- (5 pts, wet) (Define a Java interface `PalindromeCollector` of `Char` with operations `addFirst`, `addLast`, `removeFirst`, `removeLast`, `isPalindrome`, `isEmpty`, `size()`. Document **pre-/post-conditions** in clear English **without revealing any internal representation**
- (5 pts, dry) Design a concrete class `PalindromeCollectorImp` that stores chars in a **fixed-length circular array**. Declare **all fields** needed to guarantee **$O(1)$** time for **every** operation except for `isPalindrome` (bonus if you make it $O(1)$, but you will need to perform some tricky computation).
- (10 pts, dry and wet) Provide a **representation invariant expressed** in English and in the form of `boolean repOK()` method in java and describe, in English, an **abstract function** that explains, in terms of the ADT, what the concrete state means.
- (7 pts, wet) Implement in java the **5 core procedures** (`addFirst`, `addLast`, `removeFirst`, `removeLast`, `isPalindrome`) maintaining $O(1)$ except for `isPalindrome`.
- (3 pts, wet) Provide **unit tests** covering meaningful cases (e.g., empty collector, single-element collector, even-length palindrome, odd-length palindrome, non-palindrome after inserts, palindrome destroyed and restored by removal, etc).

4. Basic Blockchain System – 40 pts (wet)

Problem Description

Implement a **simplified blockchain (SB)** that acts as an **immutable distributed ledger**. The core is a **linked list of blocks**, each holding:

- A **fixed number of transactions**
- A **hash of the previous block**

Participants, identified by string **addresses** (e.g., "Alice"), can hold **BB-coin**, the SB currency. Their **balance** is also maintained by the system.

Initial **genesis block** gives **1000 BB** to address "0".

Core Components & Required Complexities

Component	Key Operations	Required Complexity
Blockchain	processTransaction, addBlock, getBlock, size, getLastBlock, getBlocks, getBalance	See below
Block	addTransaction, getFirstTransaction, removeTransaction, isFull, hash getters	O(1) except removeTransaction in O(T)
Transaction	Constructor, revert, getters	O(1)
Balance	getBalance(address)	O(A)

Where: T: number of transactions stored in **one** block, A: number of distinct addresses that currently hold a balance, n: number of blocks already in the chain.

Detailed Requirements

4.1 Interface Blockchain and class SBlockchain

Constructor

- SBlockchain() – creates genesis block with previousHash = 0, empty transaction list, and initial balance 1000 for address "0".

Methods

- processTransaction(String from, String to, int amount)
 - Adds transaction to current block.
 - If block becomes full, automatically calls addBlock().
 - Throws IllegalArgumentException if amount <= 0.
 - **Complexity:** O(T.A) when block becomes full; otherwise, O(1).
- addBlock()
 - Appends current block to chain and **executes** all transactions.
 - Failed transactions are **marked reverted**; balances **unchanged**.
 - **Complexity:** O(T.A).
- getBlock(int index) – O(n) worst-case.
- size() – O(1).
- getLastBlock() – O(1).
- getBlocks() – O(1) return of list of blocks.
- getBalance(String address) – O(A).

Extra method

boolean repOK() – validates chain integrity:

1. Balances equal sum of **non-reverted** transactions.

2. previousHash of block i equals currentHash of block $i-1$.
3. All blocks contain **same number** of transactions.
4. Block numbers **strictly increasing**.

State the **computational complexity** of `repOK()`.

4.2 Interface Balance and class BalanceImp

- `int getBalance(String address)` – returns balance or 0 if absent.
Must be $O(A)$.

4.3 Class Block

Fields: transactions, block number, blockHash, previousHash (int counters).
Maintain **insertion order**.

Constructor

- `Block(int previousHash, int transactionsPerBlock, int blockNumber)` – blockHash = previousHash + 1.

Operations

- `addTransaction(Transaction t)` – $O(1)$.
- `getFirstTransaction()` – $O(1)$.
- `removeTransaction(int index)` – $O(T)$ and preserves order.
- `isFull()` – $O(1)$.
- `getBlockHash()` / `getPreviousHash()` – $O(1)$.

Extra method

- `repOK()` – true iff `previousHash + 1 == currentHash`.

4.4 Class Transaction

Constructor

- `Transaction(String from, String to, int amount)` – throws if amount ≤ 0 or addresses invalid.

Operations

- `revert()` – marks transaction reverted.
- Getters: `getFromAddress()`, `getToAddress()`, `getAmount()`, `isReverted()`

Implementation Notes

- See general rules.
- **Do NOT use** Java's built-in classes (e.g. Queue, Stack, or LinkedList).
- Provide **your own data structures**. You can use all code we used in the tutorials 1,2 and 3.
- Supply **meaningful unit tests** covering edge cases.
- Justify **complexity analysis** for every method.
- Code must be **readable, correct, and pass all supplied tests**.